

DAVID CRABTREE

Instructional Assistant, University of Chicago Department of Political Science

Project Manager, American Bar Foundation

Research: Deterring Democratic Backsliding, Comparative Institutions

EDUCATION

University of Chicago

2023

MA, Social Sciences

GPA: 4.0

Thesis: “Chronological Sequences of Backsliding in Presidential Democracies”

Advisor: Tom Ginsburg

East Tennessee State University

2022

BA, Political Science

GPA: 4.0

BA, International Affairs

Distinguished Honors (click for link)

REVISE AND RESUBMIT

“Can Unamendable Term Limits Prevent Presidents-For-Life?” Second Round of Revisions at *Democratization*

PROFESSIONAL RESEARCH

Project Manager, *Legal Characteristics of International Organizations*

2024

Funded by National Science Foundation — Hosted by American Bar Foundation

PIs: Tom Ginsburg, University of Chicago; Kristina Daugirdas, University of Michigan

- Are IOs trending more or less democratic today? We record variation in decision-making rules and country membership over time.
- I manage a team of 10 RAs who collect and code documents detailing how each IO makes decisions and which countries are part of each IO.
- I write R scripts to integrate and clean incoming data.
- I collaborate with web developers to host our original corpus of IO legal documents online.

RESEARCH ASSISTANTSHIPS

Tom Ginsburg, *Unamendable Term Limits*, University of Chicago

2023

Read hundreds of national constitutions housed in the Comparative Constitutions Project to hand-code a global dataset of unamendable term limit provisions; generated descriptive statistics in R

Monika Nalepa, *Transitional Justice Lab*, University of Chicago

2023

Examined trends in physical repression for democratizing countries pre-transition by building graphics in R with cross-sectional time-series data

Wesley Wehde, *Welfare Attitude Survey*, East Tennessee State University

2022

Used Qualtrics to program a survey experiment estimating the effect of information regarding federal

COVID-19 relief programs on social welfare attitudes. Used R to generate descriptive statistics, graphics, and calculate average treatment effects for manuscripts

PRESENTATIONS

Nov 14, 2024. “Can Unamendable Term Limits Prevent Presidents-For-Life?” Northeastern Political Science Association Conference. Boston, MA.

TEACHING ASSISTANTSHIPS

Instructional Assistant (full time), Dept. of Political Science, University of Chicago
Honors Thesis Preceptor (Patricia Conley, AY 2023-2024; 2024-2025)
Political Science Research Methods (Patricia Conley, Fall 2024)
Electoral Politics in America (John Mark Hansen, Fall 2024)
Introduction to Comparative Politics (Michael Albertus & Benjamin Lessing, Fall 2023)
Introduction to American Politics (Ruth Bloch Rubin, x2 Winter 2024; x3 Winter 2025)
Introduction to International Relations (Paul Poast, Spring 2024; Spring 2025)
Introduction to Political Theory (Sankar Muthu; Spring 2025)
Global Studies I (Callie Maidhof, Fall 2022; separate TA-ship)

PUBLICATIONS (UNDERGRAD)

“Examining Policy Feedback Effects from COVID-19 on Social Welfare Support: Developing an Outcome Distance Dimension.” (With Wesley Wehde), Policy and Politics. (2023).

“Who Deserves What and Why During the COVID-19 Pandemic: Applying the CARIN principles of deservingness to the American welfare state.” (With Wesley Wehde), Social Policy and Administration. (2022).

AWARDS AND FELLOWSHIPS

Maroon Scholar Research Scholarship , University of Chicago 1/2 MA Tuition	<i>2022</i>
Graduate Fellowship , Phi Kappa Phi National Honors Society \$8,500 for research proposal studying democratic institutions	<i>2022</i>
Summer Research Fellowship , Honors College at East Tennessee State University \$3,500 for survey research on COVID-19’s impact on political attitudes	<i>2021</i>
President’s Academic Performance Scholarship , East Tennessee State University Highest undergraduate merit-based scholarship	<i>2019</i>

SKILLS

Programming Languages and Technical Frameworks
R, L^AT_EX, GitHub, Qualtrics, Stata

Languages
Spanish